

Copper Climbs as Traders Weigh Fed Outlook Before Inflation Data



By Jessica Zhou

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Copper gained as investors await US inflation data that could impact the Federal Reserve's stance on further interest-rate cuts.

Prices rose as much as 2% on the London Metal Exchange on Wednesday, ahead of the key economic report due Thursday. Several Fed officials are due to speak publicly, with Chicago Fed President Austan Goolsbee saying he expects  strong growth and further rate cuts next year.

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The industrial metal has rallied more than 30% this year after a series of mine disruptions cut supply. The market continues to draw support from resilient demand tied to electrification and grid investment, which has kept underlying sentiment constructive.

Still, copper has fluctuated since hitting a record of almost \$12,000 a ton on Friday. This week's uneven performance underscores the market's vulnerability to shifts in sentiment, including any cooling of optimism around artificial intelligence or economic data that could dampen broader risk appetite.

The metal traded up 1.2% to settle at \$11,737 a ton on the LME. All other metals gained, with aluminum rising 1% and tin up 3%.

— *With assistance from Mark Burton and Yvonne Yue Li*



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